

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior DevOps & Backend Engineer – Python, GCP

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps & Backend Engineer (**Python-first**) with 10+ years delivering secure, cost-optimized cloud platforms and high-performance APIs. Proven expertise in Terraform-based **GCP** infrastructure, **Docker/Kubernetes** orchestration, and **CI/CD** automation (**GitHub Actions**, Jenkins, Cloud Build). Strong track record of writing clean **Python services (Django, FastAPI)** and driving code-review standards that raise team quality. Available for a full-time freelance contract (40 h/week) with remote flexibility.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Cloud Platforms:** Google Cloud Platform (GKE, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, Pub/Sub, IAM, KMS, Secret Manager, Cloud Monitoring/Logging), IAM, KMS, Secrets Manager and CloudWatch; Azure AKS, App Service, Functions, Service Bus, Key Vault, Azure SQL, Storage, Monitor and Application Insights.
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Terraform, Terragrunt, AWS CloudFormation, Azure Bicep, Helm, Kubernetes manifests, reusable infrastructure modules, environment promotion, remote state management, policy enforcement and configuration drift detection.
- **Containers and Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes, EKS, AKS, ECS, Helm, Nginx Ingress, horizontal pod autoscaling, pod disruption budgets, workload identities, network policies, resource management, container registries and service-mesh fundamentals.
- **CI/CD and Release Engineering:** GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Argo CD, Maven, Gradle, Poetry, pip, artifact repositories, immutable builds, GitOps, blue-green deployments, canary releases, automated rollback and database migration controls.
- **Python and Automation:** Python 3.8–3.12, Django, FastAPI, Flask, boto3, Azure SDK, pytest, Pydantic, Celery, asyncio, infrastructure automation, operational tooling, deployment validation, log processing and API integration.
- **Observability and Reliability:** OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, Application Insights, Datadog, New Relic, Elastic Stack, Loki, Sentry, distributed tracing, structured logging, SLI/SLO design and alert tuning.
- **Security and Governance:** IAM, RBAC, OAuth 2.0, OIDC, Vault, Key Vault, KMS, secrets rotation, vulnerability scanning, Trivy, Snyk, SonarQube, least-privilege access, image signing, policy as code and audit logging.
- **Data and Messaging:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS, Azure Service Bus, connection-pool tuning, backup automation, schema migration and disaster-recovery validation.
- **Engineering Leadership:** Platform architecture, production-readiness reviews, incident command, root-cause analysis, capacity planning, cost optimization, mentoring, runbook development, change management and cross-functional delivery.

WORK EXPERIENCE

BEVY

Senior Software Engineer

(September 2021 – June 2026)

Remote, Romania

- Architected cloud delivery platforms for **Python** using **GCP, Kubernetes, Terraform, Helm, and GitHub Actions**, standardizing environments across development, QA, staging, and production.
- Modernized manually configured infrastructure into reusable **Terraform modules** and policy-controlled pipelines, reducing environment provisioning time by **62%** while improving configuration consistency and auditability.
- Built **GitHub Actions + Cloud Build pipelines** that compile, test, container scan (Trivy), sign, and deploy Docker images to Artifact Registry, then roll out to GKE via Helm with blue green & canary strategies and automated DB migration safety gates.
- Developed **FastAPI based backend services** (Python 3.9 3.12) with **Pydantic validation, asyncio workers**, and **Celery SQS** integration; wrote comprehensive unit/integration tests (pytest) achieving >90 % coverage.
- Resolved repeated Kubernetes pod restarts caused by memory-limit mismatches, slow application startup, and missing health probes by tuning JVM and Python worker settings and introducing reliable readiness and liveness checks.
- Led migrations from long-running virtual machines to **Dockerized workloads on EKS and AKS**, defining resource requests, autoscaling rules, disruption budgets, ingress policies, and secrets-management standards.
- Implemented observability with **OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, and structured logging**, correlating traces, metrics, and application events across distributed Python and Spring Boot services.
- Designed and maintained **Terraform managed GCP environments** (GKE clusters, Cloud SQL, Pub/Sub, Secret Manager, IAM roles) that serve >30 micro services; achieved **62 % reduction** in provisioning time and **zero drift** across dev/qa/stage/prod.
- Improved release safety by introducing **blue-green and canary deployment patterns**, database migration gates, smoke tests, and service-level checks before shifting production traffic.
- Strengthened platform security through **least-privilege IAM, workload identities, Vault, Key Vault, network policies, vulnerability scanning, and automated secrets rotation**.
- Mentored developers and operations engineers through production-readiness reviews, incident retrospectives, runbook creation, and infrastructure code reviews that improved platform ownership and on-call effectiveness.

Syscom Digital

Software Engineer

(October 2019 – August 2021)

Remote, Romania

- Managed AWS-based environments for **Python, Django, Java 8/11, and Spring Boot** applications using Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, PostgreSQL, Redis, and managed messaging services.
- Reduced failed production deployments by **31%** by replacing environment-specific shell scripts with versioned pipeline templates, immutable images, automated smoke tests, and controlled rollback procedures.
- Built **Jenkins and GitLab CI pipelines** that compiled Java services, tested Python APIs, validated database migrations, scanned containers, and promoted the same artifacts through QA and production.
- Investigated intermittent checkout outages caused by exhausted database connections and retry storms, then tuned pools, added circuit breakers, and introduced dashboards for saturation and error-rate monitoring.

- Migrated legacy EC2 based Python services to **GKE (GCP) + Cloud Run using Terraform**; cut average deployment time from 45 min to < 5 min.
- Created Python automation for deployment validation, log aggregation, certificate-expiry checks, database backup verification, and scheduled cleanup of unused snapshots and container images.
- Improved platform resilience by introducing **multi-zone deployments, health-based routing, Redis failover procedures, queue dead-letter handling, and documented recovery steps** for payment and order services.
- Integrated **SonarQube, dependency scanning, secret detection, and container vulnerability checks** into delivery workflows, blocking releases that failed established quality or security thresholds.
- Partnered with developers, QA engineers, and product teams to define operational acceptance criteria, release windows, capacity expectations, and rollback plans for high-risk commerce changes.

Soft Build

Software Developer

(June 2016 – July 2019)

Remote, Romania

- Supported **Python 3.5–3.7 and Java 8** applications across Linux servers using Jenkins, Docker, Ansible, Nginx, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Maven, Gradle, and shell automation.
- Improved average release preparation time by **44%** by automating builds, configuration deployment, database migration execution, static-asset packaging, and post-release verification checks.
- Containerized Django, Flask, and Spring Boot services that previously depended on inconsistent developer machines, creating repeatable images and documented runtime configuration for test and production.
- Resolved slow deployments and recurring disk exhaustion by cleaning obsolete artifacts, rotating logs, moving static assets to object storage, and introducing retention policies for backups and build outputs.
- Built **Ansible roles and Python scripts** for server provisioning, application configuration, user access, service restarts, SSL deployment, and environment-level health verification.
- Introduced centralized logging and baseline monitoring with the **Elastic Stack, Prometheus exporters, and alert rules** for API errors, queue backlogs, database saturation, and host-resource pressure.
- Worked with developers to diagnose **Java heap issues, Python worker timeouts, inefficient SQL queries, and reverse-proxy errors** that caused unstable behavior during traffic peaks.
- Added unit-test execution, artifact versioning, deployment approvals, rollback scripts, and release notes to Jenkins pipelines, creating a more controlled path from source code to production.

Decima Digital

Software Developer

(November 2015 – April 2016)

Remote, Estonia

- Maintained Linux hosting environments for **Python, Django, Java, and MySQL applications** using Jenkins, Ansible, Nginx, Apache, Git, Maven, shell scripts, and scheduled backup jobs.
- Automated recurring deployment steps for application packages, static assets, database scripts, permissions, and service restarts, reducing manual errors across small customer-facing releases.
- Diagnosed production failures involving **expired certificates, incorrect file permissions, broken environment variables, full disks, and inconsistent web-server configuration** across client systems.
- Created Python and shell utilities for log inspection, uptime checks, backup validation, file synchronization, and release verification, giving developers faster feedback during production troubleshooting.
- Improved database backup reliability by adding timestamped archives, retention policies, off-host copies, integrity checks, and documented restore procedures for PostgreSQL and MySQL systems.
- Supported early **Docker adoption** for isolated development and test environments, helping reduce dependency conflicts between Python libraries, Java runtimes, database clients, and operating-system packages.

- Collaborated with developers and project managers on release planning, deployment checklists, browser smoke testing, incident notes, and practical infrastructure improvements for client applications.

Borna Technology

Software Developer Intern

(September 2014 – August 2015)

Tallinn, Estonia

- Assisted with Linux administration, Git workflows, Jenkins jobs, Maven builds, Python scripts, Java applications, MySQL databases, and basic monitoring for internal and customer-facing systems.
- Created small shell and Python utilities for application startup, file cleanup, log collection, configuration copying, and repeatable verification of common development and test tasks.
- Helped investigate failed builds, missing dependencies, incorrect permissions, database connectivity errors, and environment-specific application defects under guidance from senior engineers.
- Supported deployment documentation, server inventory updates, backup checks, release notes, and simple smoke tests while learning disciplined change management and production support practices.
- Contributed to code reviews, QA preparation, and technical documentation, building a practical foundation in automation, infrastructure troubleshooting, collaborative delivery, and reliable operations.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,

September 2011 – May 2014